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By Tommaso Lecca · Aug 6, 2026, 6:24 PM · [View in your browser](#)

U.S. investment firm Apollo Global Management reached a £5.7 billion deal to take over low-cost carrier easyJet on Thursday.

The acquisition is expected to be completed in the first quarter of 2027, according to a statement to the London Stock Exchange.

Apollo's stake will be capped at 49.9 percent of easyJet in compliance with European Union foreign ownership rules for airlines holding an EU operating license. An EU trust will hold up to 5 percent of the shares.

The agreement came on the same day that Castlelake, another U.S. investment firm, withdrew from the bidding after previously offering around £5.2 billion for easyJet.

"We welcome Apollo's commitment to our business and our people, and believe that its experience in the aviation sector makes it a strong partner for easyJet," CEO Kenton Jarvis said in the statement.

Alex van Hoek, Apollo's European private equity lead, said the company "strongly supports" easyJet. The goal is to delist easyJet from the stock exchange and take it private. Apollo will evaluate the carrier's operations over the next 12 months.

EasyJet was founded in 1995 by Stelios Haji-Ioannou to offer cheap flights fares to the continent from the U.K. He and his family retain about a 15 percent stake in the carrier.

According to Gediminas Ziemelis, founder and chair of aircraft leasing company Avia Solutions Group, the transaction "raises a broader question" about whether European low-cost carriers over-invested in fleets that remain underutilized for part of the year.

"The mismatch between a summer-sized fleet and year-round ownership is the broader issue this deal highlights," he added.

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